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Stadium

3.13.6 Stadium

References:

Greek ἱππόδρομος (hippodromos) 3MA 4:11, 3MA 5:46, 3MA 6:16

Greek παλαίστρα (palaistra) 2MA 4:14

Greek στάδιον (stadion) 1CO 9:24

Description and usage:

Model of a Roman stadium (© Ray Pritz by United Bible Societies)The stadium was an open, oval area (frequently including a racetrack) around which was built an enclosed series of tiers of seats for those who came to watch the spectacles.

Translation:

In 1CO 9:24 the important feature is not the stadium as a construction, but as a place where races were conducted. Accordingly, the literal phrase "all the runners in the stadium" may very well be rendered as "all the runners who are racing." The focus here is upon the competition rather than upon the type of place in which the competition took place.

Discus

3.13.6.1 Discus

Reference:

Greek δίσκος (diskos) 2MA 4:14

Description and usage:

The discus was a round, flat disk about the size of a small dinner plate. Throwing such a disk to the greatest possible distance was part of the athletic contests of the ancient Greeks.

Translation:

Athletic contests in ancient Greece were inseparably connected with the religious cult. This is an important aspect of the discus throwing in 2MA 4:14, and this aspect should be preserved in translation, even if it means not mentioning the specific sport of throwing the discus; for example, GNT renders the last part of this verse as "they would rush off to take part in the games that were forbidden by our Law."